

The energy crisis

People around the world use energy for many different purposes—from powering cars to heating homes. Most of this energy comes from burning coal, oil, and natural gas (fossil fuels). But these fuels won't last forever, and their fumes are damaging the atmosphere.

Global warming

Burning fossil fuels fills the air with greenhouse gases, which trap some of the Sun's heat in the atmosphere. If the Earth becomes too warm, polar ice caps will melt, the sea level will rise, and deserts will spread.

Heat from the Sun enters through the atmosphere.

Greenhouse gases trap heat, although some escapes back into the atmosphere.

Nuclear power plants generate energy by splitting atoms.



Alternative energy

We need to find sources of energy other than fossil fuels—sources which cause less pollution and will not run out. Nuclear power is one option. Others possibilities include energy from sunlight, wind, and waves.



The wind provides a limitless supply of non-polluting energy. However, wind turbines are large and can be costly to set up.